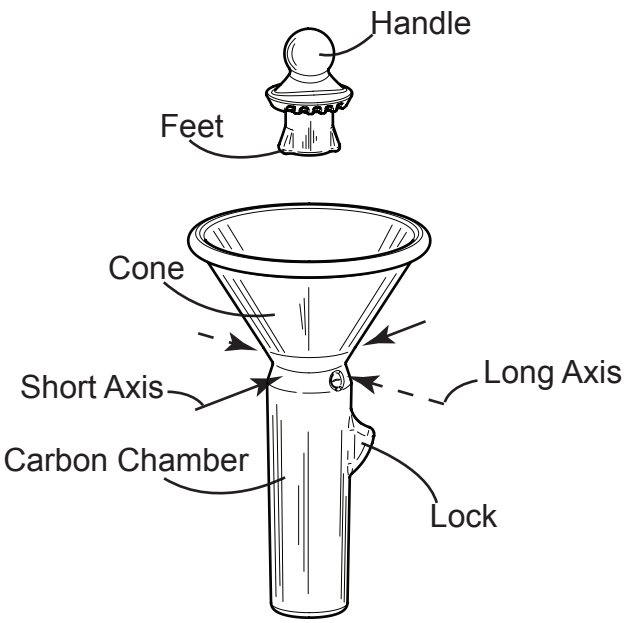
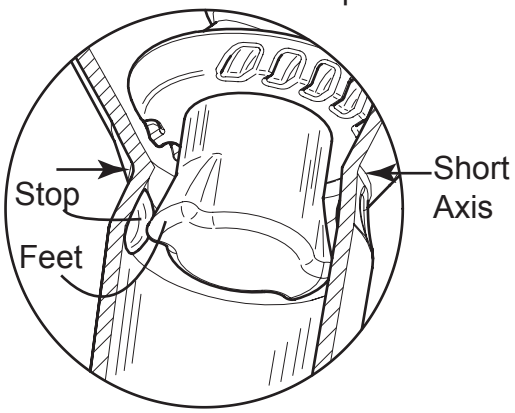
Chimera ™

Plastic-Free Carbon Filter

Your Chimera water filter fits into most cone-top carafes that have a long spout, like the leading cone topped carafe.
The Chimera's carbon chamber has an oval-shaped opening. The carbon chamber's lid has a shaft with feet that fit into the oval-shaped carbon chamber.
Once you have filled the carbon chamber with granulated activated carbon, place the lid on the top of the chamber and rotate it clockwise so that the feet slide to lock the lid in place. Once the feet meet the stops, the lid will be locked on.
Once locked, you can use the lid handle to hold the funnel and lid combination as you lift the Chimera and place it in your cone-topped carafe.
If the lid gets stuck, a little gentle wiggling will usually free it from the chamber.

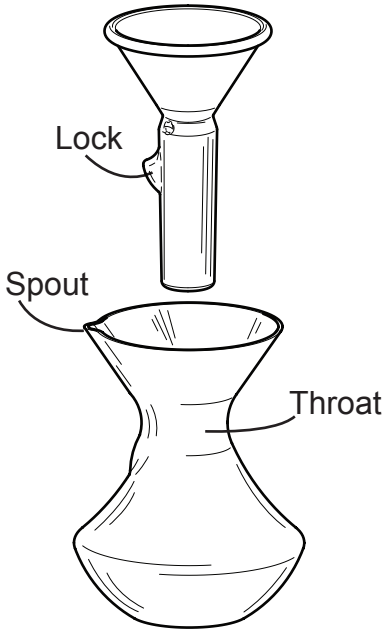


To remove the lid, gently wiggle it to loosen it from the locked position and rotate it away from the stop.



Placing the Chimera into a cone-topped carafe

Align the carbon chamber's lock with the spout of the carafe. Insert Chimera into the carafe and rotate about a quarter turn so that the lock moves away from the spout and into the throat area. This keeps the Chimera from falling out when you pour. To remove, rotate the chamber until the lock aligns with the spout and lift.



Chimera

Plastic-Free Carbon Filter

When you have filled your carbon chamber with activated carbon and inserted the Chimera into a carafe, the first pass of water through the activated carbon will be dark and cloudy. This is normal. It is carbon dust being rinsed off the granules. Your water will run clear after the first or second fill. From time to time, some carbon granules may fall through the holes at the bottom of the carbon chamber. These can be poured back into the Chimera or rinsed away.

Once a month, replace the activated carbon by removing Chimera from the carafe, removing the lid and rinsing out the used carbon. The used carbon is useful in compost as it makes a home for the microbes that produce nitrogen in the soil. Carbon will not release the toxins that it has adsorbed unless it is heated to boiling temperature, so it won't harm your soil.

How Activated Carbon Removes PCBs

Activated carbon filters water through a process called adsorption (not absorption), a physical-chemical process where contaminants adhere to the vast, porous surface of the carbon granules. As water flows through the carbon granules, millions of microscopic pores trap organic compounds. Activated carbon is treated to create millions of pores providing a vast surface area, up to 1,400 square meters per gram. Contaminants are physically or chemically attracted to the surface of the carbon particles rather than being absorbed into them. For substances like chlorine, the carbon triggers a chemical reaction that converts it into harmless chloride ions, eliminating bad tastes and odors. Activated carbon is highly effective at removing organic pollutants including volatile organic compounds (VOCs), pesticides, herbicides, industrial solvents and chlorine. The longer water stays in contact with the carbon, the more effective the filtration. Your Chimera filter is designed to hold the carbon in the water so that it may continuously remove pollutants.

Activated carbon filtration is a commonly used and effective method for removing PCBs from drinking water. PCBs, which are organic compounds, are attracted to the porous surface of activated carbon and stick to it. This process's efficiency depends on the contact time between the water and the carbon.